

ACHIEVE!



Geography

Indigenous Contexts

Jennifer Leigh-Jones



Made for the
Australian Curriculum

Achieve! Geography

Get ready for the Australian Curriculum with editable work sheets that have been written to assist teachers to embed the cross-curriculum themes of Indigenous histories and cultures, Australia's place in the Asian region, and sustainability.

Features

- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills
- ✓ Emphasis on understanding essential geography concepts and content
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes that provide clear lesson objectives, background information, starter and extension activities
- ✓ CD-ROM containing all pages from the book making them ideal for use on IWBs
- ✓ Word files on the CD-ROM that can be edited to suit the specific needs of students



Software requirements

Windows – MS Word 97 or higher, Adobe Acrobat Reader

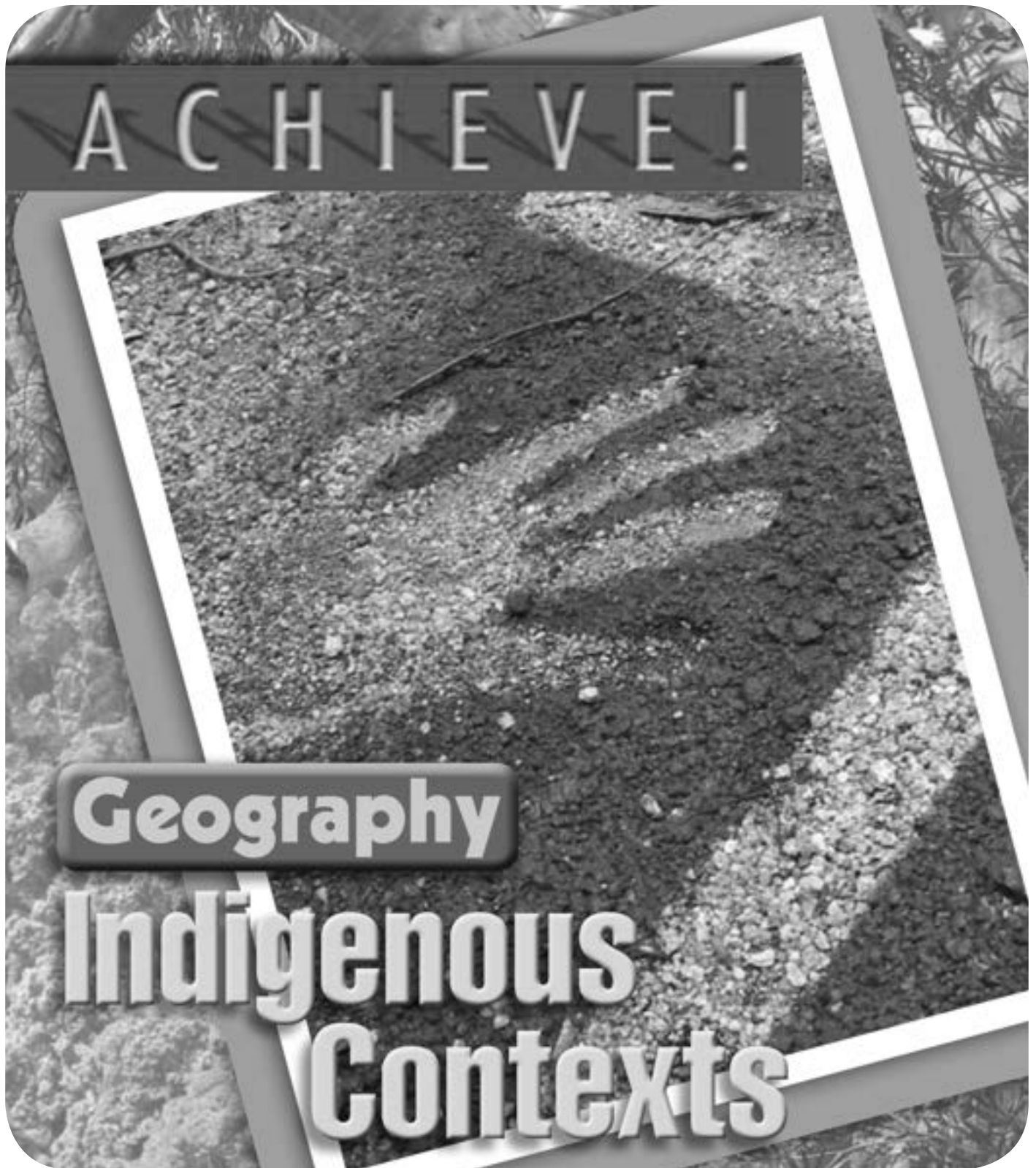
Mac – MS Word 98 or higher, Adobe Acrobat Reader



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The *Achieve!* series of Geography titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

The work sheets are designed to assist secondary school geography teachers to implement one of the three cross-curriculum priorities of the Australian Curriculum concerning Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander histories and cultures. This book contains information and activities about Indigenous cultural beliefs and understandings of Australian geography, as well as current data concerning Indigenous populations.

Blake Education advises that this book and the resources suggested within may contain names and images of people who have died, which may be offensive or distressing to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people. Teachers should advise Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander students of this possibility.

In some Indigenous Australian cultures it may be culturally inappropriate for women to touch or play a didgeridoo. Teachers should ensure they encourage respect for different cultural beliefs.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, each of which generally contains one or more Resource sheets and several Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

- **Objectives** – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.
- **Prior knowledge** – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others. However, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.
- **Background** – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.
- **Starter activity** – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.
- **Resource and Activity work sheets** – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity work sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the student.
- **Extension ideas** – Additional tasks are suggested to recap on the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, as well as ways to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

Teacher's notes – Origins of the Australian continent

Achieve!

Objectives

- To understand the concept of supercontinents
- To understand the concept of plate tectonics
- To learn that Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples are the original inhabitants of Australia

Prior knowledge

- Students should have some familiarity with a map of the world and should be able to identify the continents.

Background

Pangea is the name given to the supercontinent that once contained all the continents of the earth. It began to break into Laurasia in the Northern Hemisphere and Gondwana in the Southern Hemisphere about 200 million years ago. Eventually, Laurasia and Gondwana broke up and the continents drifted apart very slowly to their present locations.

In 1912 Alfred Wegener, a German meteorologist, presented his theory of continental drift and suggested that the continents had once fitted together. However, the idea was not supported by the scientists of the time. When evidence of plate tectonics was discovered, scientists revisited Wegener's ideas. The theories of continental drift and plate tectonics were accepted about 50 years ago. These theories helped people understand the dynamism of the earth and why earthquakes and volcanic eruptions occur in specific areas.

The concept of geological time compared to human time needs to be explored in order to put the movement of the continents, and particularly the origin of Australia and its first inhabitants, into perspective. The melting of ice caps raised the sea level and formed Tasmania. It also changed what we now know as Central Australia and demonstrates that climate change has always occurred.

Starter activity

Brainstorm what the students know about how earth's continents came to be arranged as they are. Students could visit:

<http://austhrutime.com/venerable.htm>

to research the origins of Indigenous Australia.

Discuss the difference between geological time – millions of years – compared with the first settlement of Australia about 60 000 years ago.

Ask students for their ideas about how Indigenous people came to Australia, and where they came from.

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Resource sheet, 'Origins of the Australian continent', with the students. Given the continents that made up Gondwana, have students list the continents that must have made up Laurasia. Students could create a glossary in their workbooks, including *supercontinent*, *Gondwana*, *Pangea* and two more words of their own choice.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'The continents'. They will need an atlas and the Resource sheet, 'Origins of the Australian continent'.

Provide students with the Activity sheet, 'Sunda and Sahul'. Discuss the technique of using shading to show the amount of land there was during the Pleistocene era. You could explain that the sea level was lower due to lower temperatures which meant more water was stored in ice at the north and south of the earth.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Origins'. Discuss the diagrams with the students, and point out the vast amounts of time between the eras shown. Students will complete a cloze activity about the theories of continental drift and plate tectonics.

Read the Resource sheet, 'Understanding our origins', with the students. If they are keeping a glossary, students could add the terms *Indigenous*, *archeologist* and *Sahul*. To extend the activity, you could do a class Internet search for maps of early human migration and discuss what you find out.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Origin match-up', in which they will match definitions to key terms. Students may need to refer to the Resource and Activity sheets in the unit.

Extension activity

- Use the Internet to find out where recent earthquakes have occurred and what has happened to the land and people.
- Research the movement of Indigenous people from the north of Australia to the rest of the continent. Students will find that the coastal and tropical areas were colonised first, but eventually desert areas and the Tasmanian highlands were also colonised.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

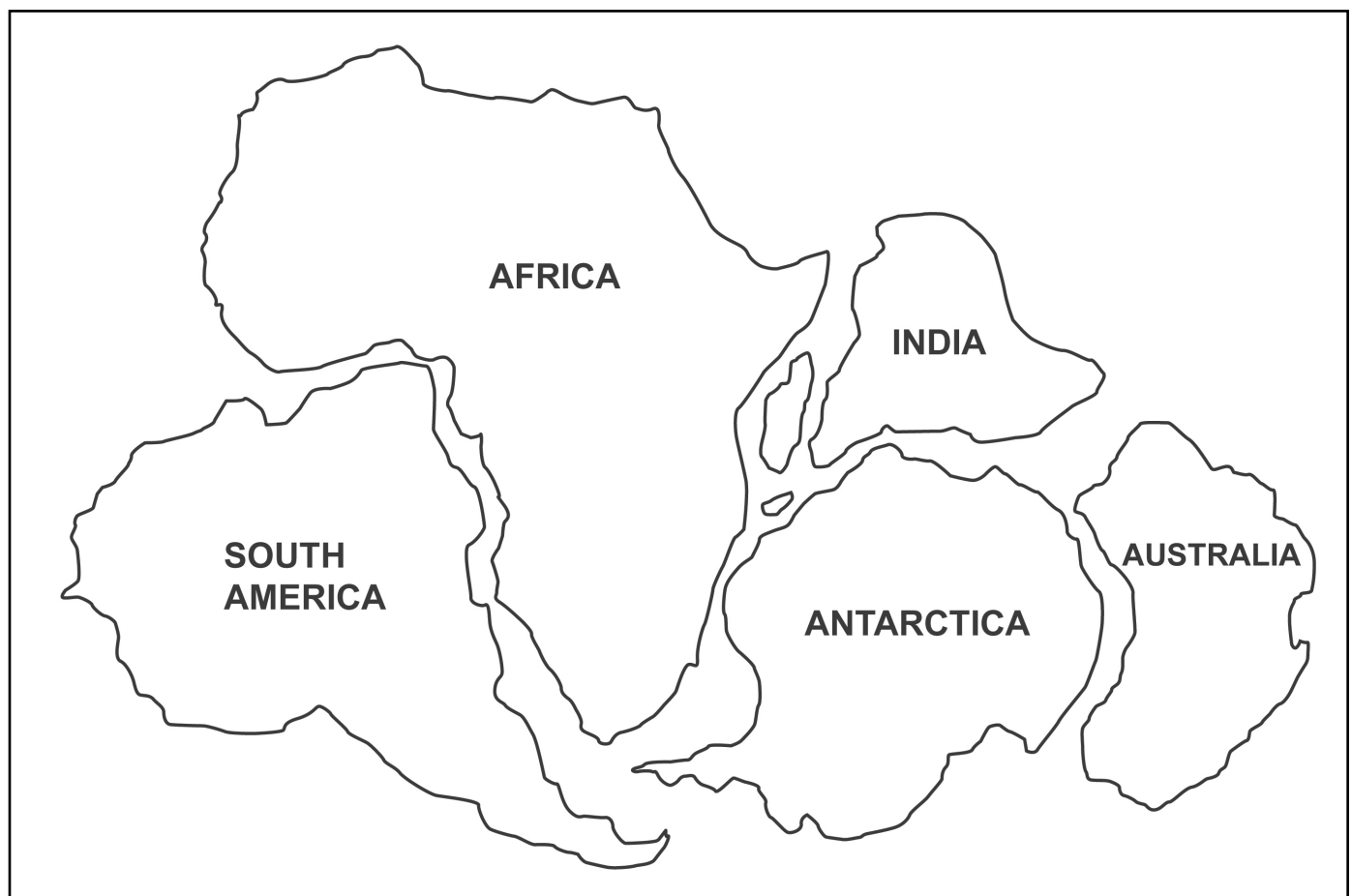
Origins of the Australian continent

It is hard to imagine now, but Australia was once part of a huge **supercontinent** named **Gondwana** which existed mostly in the southern hemisphere. Before that, Gondwana was part of **Pangea** (Greek for 'all lands'), a massive supercontinent made up of all the continents we know now.

Pangea began splitting into Gondwana and **Laurasia** – another supercontinent – about 200 million years ago. Gondwana was enormous, made up of present-day Africa, South America, India, Australia and Antarctica.

How do we know? Some of the same kinds of rocks and fossils are found across the modern land masses that made up Gondwana, but not anywhere else.

In 1861, an Austrian geologist named Eduard Suess first suggested the theory that Gondwana had existed. Suess realised that the fossil plant *Glossopteris* (a fern-like tree) could be found in all the land masses of the former Gondwana, and decided that this meant these lands were once joined together. Suess named Gondwana after a district in India where the fossil plant was found.



The continents

-  **1** Read the Resource sheet, 'Origins of the Australian continent'.

Use an atlas to locate and label the continents on the map below.

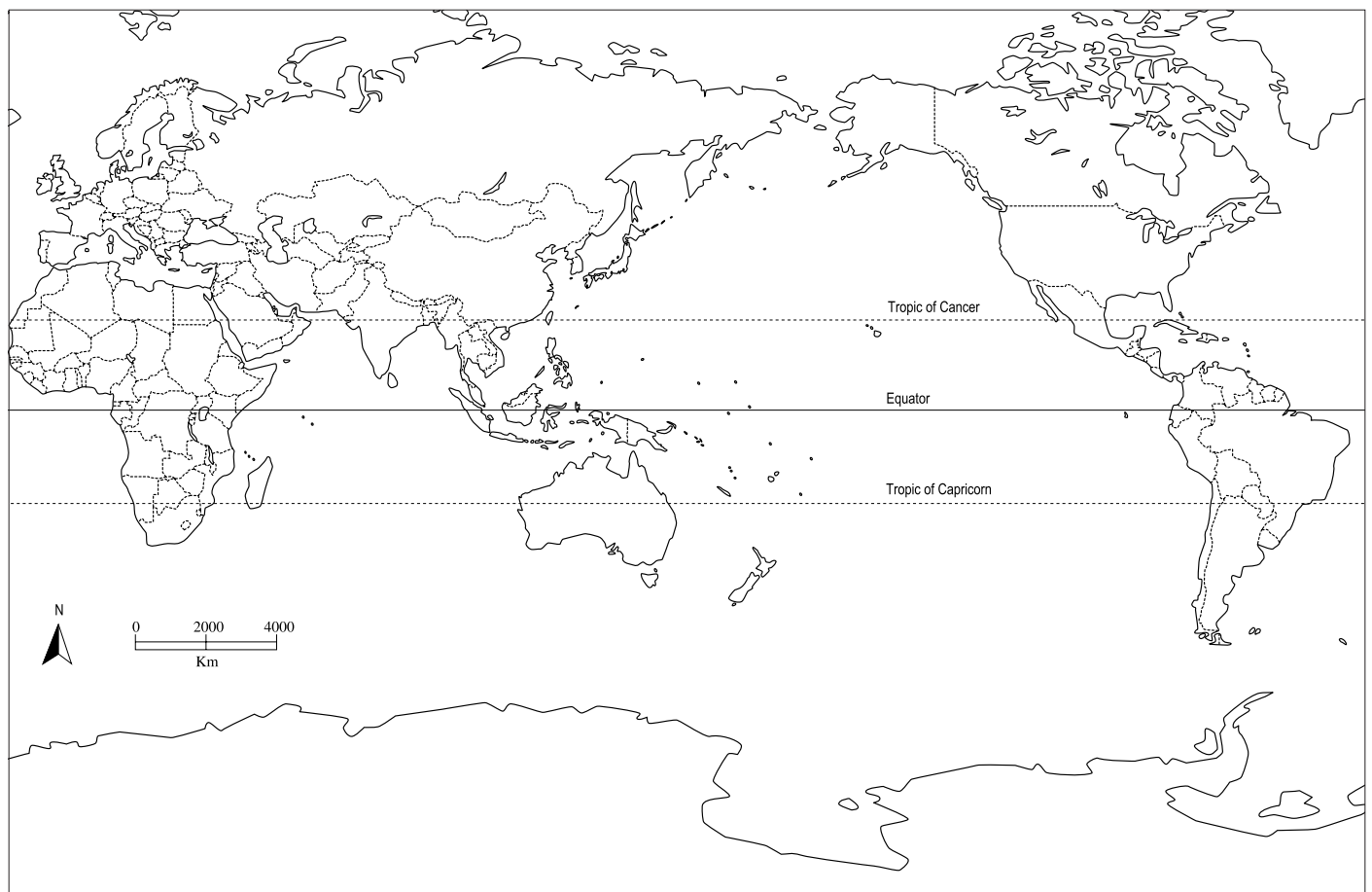
Then locate and label India, Madagascar and New Zealand.

- 2** Colour the land masses which made up Gondwana in green.

- 3** Which of these land masses are now in the northern hemisphere?

- 4** What does this tell you about the movement of the plates?

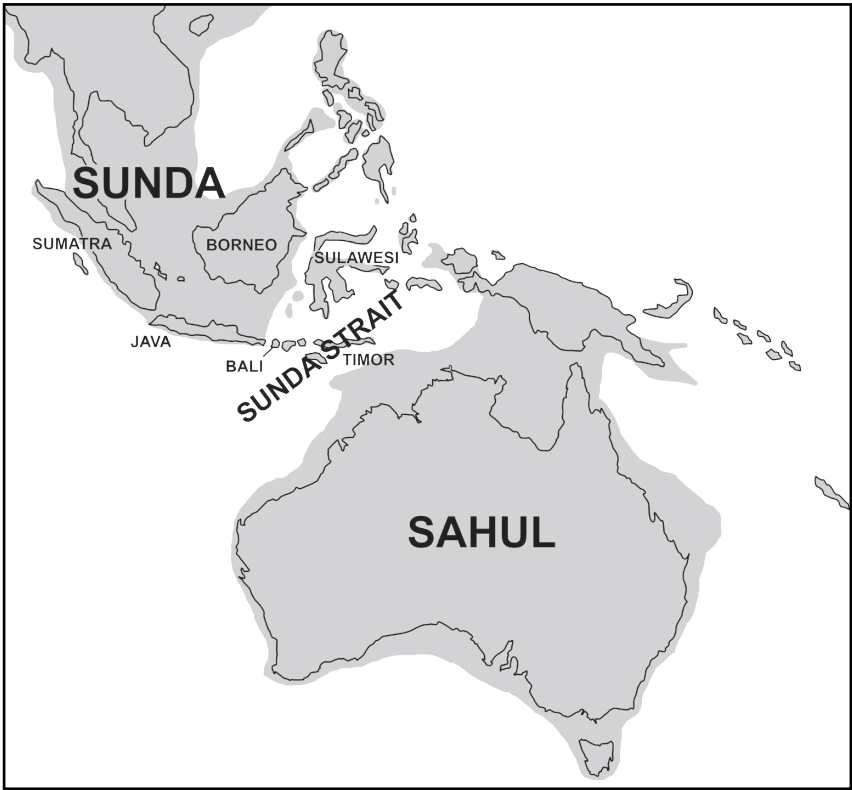
- 5** What do you notice about the modern continent of Australia in comparison to Gondwana?



Sunda and Sahul

Has Australia looked the same since it began to drift north from Antarctica about 96 million years ago?

During the geological era known as the Pleistocene (from 2.5 million to 12 000 years ago), the sea level was up to 150 metres lower than it is today. The shaded area on the map shows what the land looked like then. Tasmania was still joined to the mainland of Australia, which was joined to New Guinea. This land mass was known as Sahul. Sahul was separated from **Sunda**, another land mass, by the Sunda Strait.



 1 List the countries that now make up the original Sunda and Sahul.

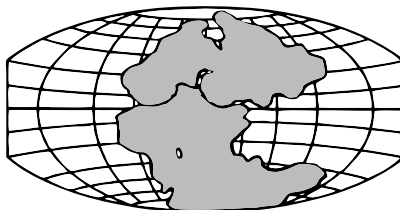
2 Mark each statement as true or false.	T	F
a) The Australian continent drifted south from Antarctica.	☐	☐
b) During the Pleistocene era, the sea level was up to 150 metres lower than it is today.	☐	☐

Origins

-  **1** Write a dot point below each diagram to describe how the land masses change over time.

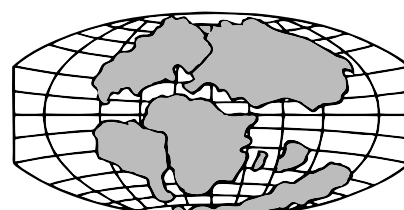
Permian era

225 million years ago



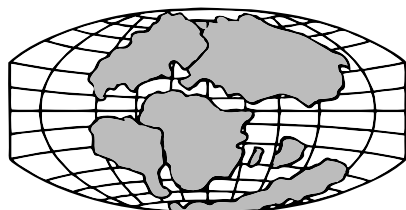
Triassic era

200 million years ago



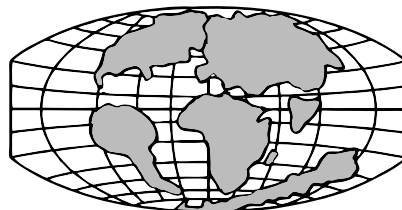
Jurassic era

135 million years ago

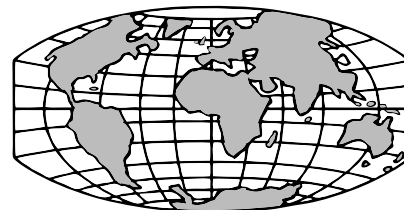


Cretaceous era

65 million years ago



Present day



- 2** Complete the sentences using the word bank.

In 1912 Alfred Wegener, a German _____, presented his theory of continental drift and suggested that the _____ had once fitted together. However, the idea was not _____ by the scientists at the time.

When evidence of plate _____ was discovered, scientists revisited Wegener's ideas. The theories of continental drift and plate tectonics were _____ about 50 years ago. These theories helped people understand why _____ and volcanic eruptions occur in specific areas.

Word bank

accepted
continents
earthquakes
meteorologist
supported
tectonics

Understanding our origins

- It is believed that Australia's Indigenous people came to Australia through South-East Asia. The first human **migration** was probably when Australia was part of the Sahul **land mass**. However, there were still large areas of water, so people needed boats or rafts to get from Sunda to Sahul. These people may have come via modern-day Malaysia.
- Indigenous Australians are the original inhabitants of Australia and its nearby islands. Indigenous people who live on the Australian mainland, Tasmania and islands such as Flinders Island and King Island are often called 'Aboriginal'. The Indigenous people who inhabit islands near Cape York are called Torres Strait Islanders.
- The oldest Aboriginal remains were those of Mungo Man, found near **Lake Mungo** in New South Wales. Mungo Man is believed to be about 50 000 years old.
- Humans reached Tasmania about 40 000 years ago by travelling across a land bridge from the mainland. About 12 000 years ago, the glacial ice melted and the sea level rose to present-day levels, creating Bass Strait. The people in Tasmania were isolated from the mainland until European settlers arrived.

Origin match-up

 1 Discuss the terms in the table below with your class or group.
Then write the correct meaning beside each term.

Term	Meaning
Pangea	
Continent	
Gondwana	
Fossil	
Archeologist	
Sahul	
Indigenous people	
Tectonic plates	
Geologist	
Supercontinent	

Meanings

- Several land masses joined together
- Person who studies ancient cultures and their people
- A large, continuous expanse of land
- Greek word meaning ‘all lands’
- Sections of the earth’s crust that move in relation to one another
- First inhabitants of a place
- Name of southern hemisphere supercontinent
- Person who studies rocks of the earth
- Name given to the land mass that included New Guinea and Australia
- Remains or impressions of prehistoric plants or animals preserved in rock

Objectives

- To understand the importance of mythology in prehistory
- To appreciate the significance of the Dreaming to the lives of Indigenous Australians
- To understand the relationship between the Dreaming stories and the Australian landscape

Prior knowledge

Students should have some experience of using storytelling to pass on information and ideas.

Background

Stories played an important role in prehistoric times. *Prehistory* means 'before written records', and during this time people told stories to explain creation, the formation of physical features and natural phenomena like thunder, rainbows and stars. These stories taught people about traditions, culture and how they should live. They were told from generation to generation, and represented through dance, song and painting.

Starter activity

Ask students to imagine what life was like before people used written language. Ask questions such as: How do you think people communicated with each other? Could they communicate with people who lived far away? How could they remember or record important events? Tell students that we use the term 'prehistory' to describe the time before people used written language.

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Resource sheet, 'Dreamtime, landscape and lifestyle', with the students. Discuss the idea that the significance of the Dreaming forms the basis of Indigenous life, past and present, and is acknowledged in 'Welcome to Country' greetings at public ceremonies today.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Understanding the Dreamtime', where they summarise what they have learned from the Resource sheet, 'Dreamtime, landscape and lifestyle'. Discuss their answers as a class, and have students revise or add to their own answers to incorporate class ideas.

Provide students with the Activity sheet, 'Creation story – the Rainbow Serpent'. Point out that many different tribes have their own versions of creation stories. Explain that this type of story tells of the creation of the landforms, vegetation and animals, as well as human society. Students will use vowels to complete the verbs in a version of the Rainbow Serpent story.

Read the Resource sheet, 'How were landforms created?', with the students. Make sure students understand the meaning of the geological terms shown in bold. Explain that the Indigenous explanations are examples, and have been summarised. Students may wish to use the library or Internet to find out more about these explanations.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Finding landforms', students will need an atlas and the Resource sheet, 'How were landforms created?' They will complete a mapping task and comprehension questions about the information on the Resource sheet.

Extension ideas

Research a detailed Indigenous explanation of the geographic features of Uluru at: www.austhrutime.com/mythology_uluru.htm
Other landforms such as Wave Rock, the Darling Scarp, Wilpena Pound, Arkaroola and the Grampians also have interesting stories to explain their existence. You can find information about these stories by selecting 'Aboriginal Australia' on the left menu of the www.austhrutime.com website, and scrolling down the list of articles.

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Dreamtime, landscape and lifestyle

- For thousands of years, Indigenous Australians have told stories to pass their culture from **generation** to generation. **Dreaming stories** told Indigenous Australians about how to live their lives.
- In the Dreaming stories, there are close links between the physical, human and spiritual worlds. The stories are told through song, dance and painting, as well as speaking.
- **The Dreaming** relates to the time of creation, when the Spirit Ancestors came out of the earth. They moved across the land and created sacred places. They made important features of the landscape like mountains, rivers, lakes and waterholes. They made **flora** and **fauna**, and the laws of the landscape too. Their movements are recorded in **Dreaming Tracks**, which join the sites the **Ancestral Beings** passed.
- Dreaming stories tell about the Indigenous culture and customs, and the laws of the community. They also explain how people should behave and the consequences of disobedience, including punishments.
- In the stories, living sustainably and caring for the land and its features, plants and animals, are an important part of the traditions and culture.
- Dreaming stories also contain practical information such as where food grows and in which season it ripens. Indigenous people believe that each type of food was created by the Spirit Ancestors.
- **Totems** are objects of nature which become family emblems. They are given to people in certain areas. Some people are given personal totems at birth. Totems are important in song and dance.

Understanding the Dreamtime

Read the Resource sheet, 'Dreamtime, landscape and lifestyle', and answer the questions.

 **1** What do Indigenous Australians mean by **the Dreaming**?

2 What is the purpose of the Dreaming stories?

3 How is the culture of Indigenous Australians passed on?

4 What do the Dreaming stories tell people?

5 What is meant by:

 a) the physical world?	 b) the human world?	 c) the spiritual world?
		

Creation story – the Rainbow Serpent

Stories provided Indigenous people with a map of the land and knowledge of food sources and trade routes.

There are a number of Dreaming creation stories, and many individual landforms have their own creation stories. Although it varies from region to region, the oldest continuing story is that of the **Rainbow Serpent**.

The Rainbow Serpent is always associated with water sources such as rivers, creeks, **lagoons** and **billabongs**.

It was the protector of the land and the people, and the source of all life. But if it was not properly respected, it could turn people into rocks, mountains and other landforms.

 **1** Use vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the verbs (doing words) in the story.



A version of the Rainbow Serpent story from Katherine in the Northern Territory

The Rainbow Serpent slept under the ground until she w__k__ up and pushed her way to the surface. Then she moved across the land, sleeping when she became t__r__d.

She returned to the place where she had first __ppear__d and called to the frogs to come out, but they were very slow because their tummies were full of water. The Rainbow Serpent tickl__d them and when the frogs la__ghed, the water flowed out of their mouths and filled the tracks and hollows left by the Rainbow Serpent, cr__at__ng the rivers and lakes.

With water, grass and trees began to appear. This woke all the animals, who f__ll__wed the Rainbow Serpent across the land. The Rainbow Serpent m__d__ laws to be obeyed by all. Those who kept the laws were t__rned into humans and given totems from where they came, like kangaroos, emus and snakes.

How were landforms created?

Indigenous explanation	Geological explanation
Uluru , Northern Territory	
The south side resulted from a battle between the Liru, the poisonous snakes, and the Kunia, the carpet snakes.	Hard sandstone rock was laid down under the sea millions of years ago. The surrounding softer material has been worn away over time, leaving the monolith , Uluru.
Kandimal (Wolfe Creek Crater), Western Australia	
Two Rainbow Snakes moved across the country, carving the paths of Stuart Creek and Wolfe Creek. The crater formed where the snakes came out of the earth.	Wolfe Creek Crater is the second biggest meteorite crater in the world. The meteorite hit the earth 2 million years ago.
Lake Eyre , South Australia	
Wikuda, a young boy, chased a white kangaroo and speared it. Wikuda put the skin down east of Anna Creek. The skin became Lake Eyre.	Once covered by the sea, Lake Eyre is now 15 metres below sea level and salty. The wind has removed the sand. Now water flows in from the Diamantina River and Cooper Creek.
Buda-dji (Barron Gorge), Queensland	
Buda-dji, shaped like a carpet snake, carved out the famous gorge.	Formed by the River Barron cutting down through the escarpment on its path to the sea.
Murray River , New South Wales, Victoria, South Australia	
Pondi the Murray cod was chased by the Ngurenderi the hunter from New South Wales to Lake Alexandrina, making the bends and banks of the river as he dodged and weaved his way.	The source of the river is a spring near Mt Kosciuszko. The river collects water from the tributaries as it flow to the sea through the mouth of the river, in South Australia.
The Three Sisters , New South Wales	
Three sisters, Meenhi, Wimlah and Gunnedoo, were turned to stone as punishment for meeting three men they were not supposed to see.	Sand was deposited in the sea where it hardened into sandstone. The land was uplifted and the sandstone was worn away by rain and wind, leaving the three rocks.

Finding landforms

-  **1** Use an atlas to find the geographic features listed in the Resource sheet 'How were landforms created?' Mark them on the map below.



- 2** Suggest why rivers and creeks flow into Lake Eyre.

- 3** What did the rainbow snakes create at Wolf Creek Crater?

- 4** Where is the mouth of the Murray River?

- 5** Draw lines to join each sentence beginning to the correct sentence ending.

Sentence beginnings

Indigenous people have stories that

These stories are based on their observations

The geological explanations for how landforms are created are

Sentence endings

of the land and their spiritual beliefs.

based on observations of the land and theories about the forces that affect it.

explain how landforms are created.

Objectives

- To understand the meaning of the term 'hunters and gatherers'
- To appreciate the need to look after the land
- To identify differences between Indigenous and European use of the land

Prior knowledge

Students should be aware that there are different ways of using and caring for the land.

Background

Early Indigenous Australians gained all the nourishment they needed while living sustainably on the land. The kinds of foods eaten by different tribes varied according to their location and the season. Dreamtime stories told them how to care for the land and its resources. Water became sacred, and in some areas wells were dug to tap underground supplies. Fire played an important part in warmth, cooking and hunting. Tribes would burn off areas at particular times of the year to encourage grass to grow. This provided a food source for the animals they hunted. The use of fire changed the vegetation, with fire-resistant species such as eucalypts and acacias becoming dominant.

Starter activity

Work with the class to define these key terms which are used throughout the unit: **nomadic, semi-nomadic, cannibalism, sustainable, aromatic, legalised, hunters and gatherers.**

Resource and Activity sheets

Provide students with the Activity sheet, 'Hunting and gathering'. Then discuss how this way of finding food compares with the way people obtain food today. Introduce the idea of a global food chain, and compare it with the local supply of food Indigenous people relied on.

Have students read the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous methods of finding food'. Discuss

the importance of sustainable use of resources to Indigenous Australians, and how sustainability relates to food supply today. For example, more people are growing their own vegetables and fruit, eat foods that are in season and are concerned about food miles and other environmental factors associated with food production.

To complete the Activity sheets, 'Finding food' and 'Sustainable land use', students will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous methods of finding food'.

Read the Activity sheet, 'Food preparation', with the students. Through this activity, students will gain an understanding of how Indigenous Australians ensured a constant food supply despite limited options for storing food. They will also learn about the availability today of some traditional foods.

On the Activity sheet, 'Use of resources', students complete a cloze exercise exploring the kinds of tools and equipment Indigenous Australians made, and how they were used. Students may need assistance with finding illustrations of the tools from online or library sources for the second part of the activity.

Extension ideas

- Have students work in small groups to research the availability of bush tucker – in their local area, Australia-wide and internationally. Students could also compile a collection of recipes that use these ingredients.
- Visit the Indigenous plant section of the local Botanical Gardens, and look for plants that can be used as food sources. Make sure the students understand that it is not safe to eat these plants unless they are taught how to prepare them correctly.

Hunting and gathering



Read the information below and answer the following questions.

Indigenous Australians were very skilful **hunters** and **gatherers**. The types of foods they ate varied according to where they lived – in deserts, tropical rainforests or mountains, along the coast or near rivers. Food sources also varied according to the seasons.



The traditional Indigenous diet has all the vitamins and minerals that people need. Indigenous people have a detailed knowledge of the foods in their area, and only collected or hunted what they needed and what was in season.

Indigenous Australians ate many different types of foods. If a food they usually ate wasn't available, for example during a drought, they simply ate something else, or moved to a different part of their tribal area.

The locations of waterholes were passed down from generation to generation. Many of these sites, such as those at Uluru, became sacred.

1 What factors determine which foods Indigenous people eat?

2 What makes the Indigenous diet healthy?

3 How do Indigenous people make sure they have enough food?

4 Where does information about water come from?

5 Suggest why waterholes became sacred.

Indigenous methods of finding food

Indigenous people traditionally led a **nomadic** life inland and a **semi-nomadic** life near the coast and rivers. They knew how to care for the land, and only took what they needed so that their land use was **sustainable**.

Men and women spent most of the day collecting food. Women **dug up** yams and other roots as well as collecting seeds. Women and children collected ants, honey ants and witchetty grubs and killed small animals with digging sticks. Men hunted in groups when catching kangaroos and emus, and hunted alone to catch small animals like possums, snakes and birds.

People along rivers and near the coast caught fish. There is a fish trap at Brewarrina in New South Wales that is 40 000 years old, and is still being used. Coastal tribes **collected** oysters, mussels and crabs, which are a good source of energy.

When hunting, people used fire to scare out animals so they could kill them. People also set fire to certain areas at particular times of year to encourage grass to grow. This helped to feed the animals and sustain their numbers, so that there were enough for people to hunt. Over time, fire has changed the environment by encouraging fire-resistant plants to grow.

If a person's **totem** was a particular bird, animal or plant, they would not kill or eat that thing, as this was regarded as **cannibalism**.

Water was **sourced** from rivers and waterholes. When these dried up, tribes had to move in search of more water.

At times, tribes would meet to socialise through feasting, perform ceremonies and trade with each other. Often it was the harvesting of a particular food source that brought people together. For example, when Bogong moths migrated to the Snowy Mountains during summer, tribes from around the area would meet and feast on the roasted moths. The bunya nut festival in the Bunya Mountains, Queensland, is another example.

Finding food

 1 Read the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous methods of finding food'. List the key points under each heading in the boxes below.

How much time did it take to collect food?	What did women and children gather and catch?	What did men catch?

Care of the land	Water supply	Role of food in socialising

Sustainable land use

 **1** Read the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous methods of finding food'. Then answer the questions below.

2 Why were Indigenous Australians **nomadic** or **semi-nomadic**?

3 How was their use of the land **sustainable**?

4 Explain how the Indigenous Australians used fire.

5 Read each statement below and decide whether it is true or false. Place a tick in the correct column.

Statement	True	False
Men hunted small animals, such as possums, snakes and birds, in groups.		
When a river dried up, the tribe had to move.		
If a person's totem was a kangaroo, they would only eat kangaroo.		
Children did not help to gather food.		

6 Correct and rewrite any false statements from question 4.

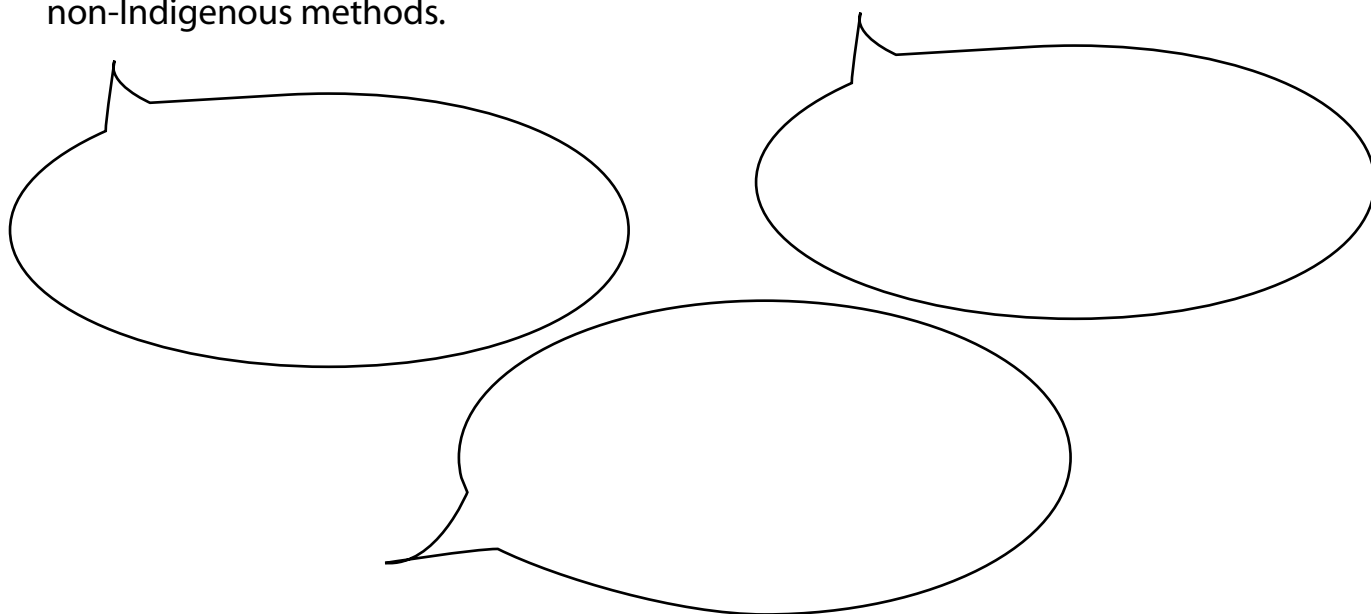
Food preparation

 **1** Cross out the incorrect word inside each set of brackets.

A lot of food was eaten (raw / rawe) by Indigenous Australians. Meat was cooked quickly on hot (coals / koles), mostly to remove feathers and fur, but it was not cooked all the way through. Some (cedes / seeds) were ground between stones to make flour, which could be made into cakes to be cooked on the fire or in stone ovens. Food could not be (storred / stored), but it was preserved in a few places. For example, (fish / fisch) were smoked in hollow gum trees along the lower River Murray and strips of (kangeroo / kangaroo) were sun-dried in some central (desert / dessert) areas.

In the 1970s, non-Indigenous Australians began to understand the use of native foods. Gradually kangaroo meat was **legalised** for sale, and then emu and crocodile (meet / meat). **Aromatic** plants like lemon myrtle and fruits and nuts such as quandong, Paterson's plum and macadamia nuts, have become available. Some restaurants specialise in 'bush tucker' while others offer (native / natif) foods on their menus.

2 List three differences between traditional Indigenous Australian food preparation and non-Indigenous methods.



3 What does the availability of 'bush tucker' such as kangaroo, crocodile and emu meat tell you about the non-Indigenous understanding of Indigenous Australian life?

Use of resources

 1 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

Indigenous Australians used plants, stones, _____ and bones to make tools. They made bags from bush string and _____ grass stalks and used them to carry seeds and _____. Some bags were so closely woven they could be used to carry _____.

Stones were used to grind _____ into flour. In the centre of Australia, people used stones to make tips for their _____. Fishbone was used to tip some weapons found in _____ areas.

People used wood to make spears, boomerangs, coolamons and digging _____. Wood was also used to make carved _____ sticks, which groups of people used to communicate. The earliest _____ were made from bark and were left to rot after they had been used to collect fish, eels and birds' _____. In some areas, canoes were cut from trees – especially in the Murray-Darling Basin. A canoe from the Melbourne region is now displayed in the Museum of Victoria.

Word bank

canoes

coastal

eggs

fruit

honey

knotted

message

seeds

spears

sticks

wood

2 Use the Internet or library to find illustrations of these items. Draw and label them to show how each item was used.

Grinding stone	String bag	Coolamon
Digging stick	Spear	Boomerang

Objectives

- To understand the significance of Indigenous art as a way to record thoughts, beliefs and early ways of life
- To appreciate the Indigenous connection to the Dreaming
- To realise that Indigenous art is found in other continents
- To understand that Indigenous Australian painting is considered the oldest continuous art form known today

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of the Dreaming and its importance to Indigenous life.

Background

Art using a variety of mediums has been a means of expression for people for thousands of years. Petroglyphs and rock art in caves, overhangs and on boulders have contributed to our current understanding of pre-history. Humans have always used art in its many forms to record information and ideas about spirituality, lifestyle and food sources. Some Indigenous paintings of sailing ships and buffalo hunting depict contact with European people. As Indigenous Australian art is so significant, both for its spirituality and the history it records, it is essential that it be respected and preserved for all Australians. Many modern Indigenous Australian artists continue to pass on stories of spirituality and country using traditional symbols and colour.

Starter activity

Discuss why people create art, both today and in the past. Ensure students understand the distinction between pre-history (before use of a formal writing system) and history (when written records were kept). Explore what can be learned from early art and why it is important to our understanding of the past.

Resource and Activity sheets

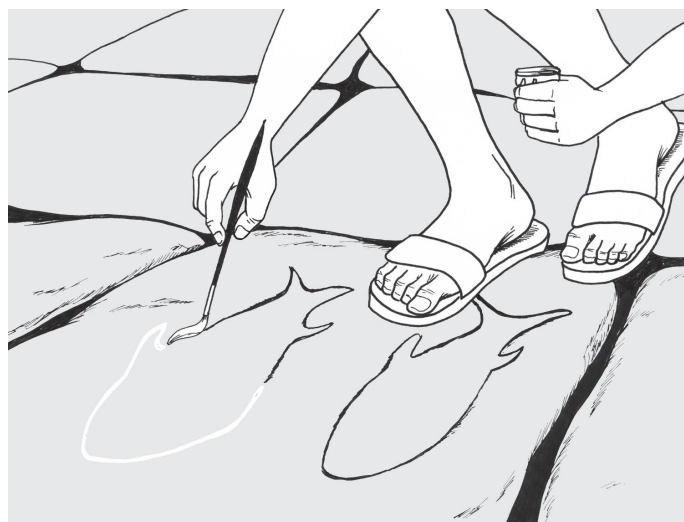
Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Rock art'. As they complete the cloze exercises they will gain an overview of Indigenous art in Australia.

Read and discuss the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous art styles', with the class. Make sure students understand the meaning of each term shown in bold. Then have students complete the questions on the Activity sheet, 'Different kinds of rock art'. To extend the activity, you could help students use the library or Internet to find examples of each type of art.

Have students read the Resource sheet, 'Threats to rock art'. Discuss the ways some is threatened, both intentionally and unintentionally. Then have students complete the Activity sheet, 'How can we help protect rock art?' Suggestions could include boardwalks to keep people on a given path, fences to keep people and animals at a safe distance from the art, car parks, fines, signs, educational and cautionary pamphlets and getting local Indigenous Australians or rangers to remove nests and plants and keep the paintings drained.

Extension ideas

- Use a map of Australia to locate the art mentioned in the unit. Have the students suggest why the art is located in those places.
- Visit a museum or art gallery to look at Indigenous art and artefacts. Alternatively, the website of the Australian Museum shows an extensive collection.



Rock art

1 Use the words from the word bank to complete the information below.

Word bank

non-Indigenous engraving past identity continuous
wallabies shelters people thousands caves sandstone timeline

Indigenous Australian art is considered the oldest _____ art form in the world. Australia has _____ of rock art sites. Most of them are in the northern part of the country.

The first form of Indigenous art was painting or _____ on large rocks and the walls of rock _____ and _____.

In 2010, it was reported that rock art in Central Arnhem Land displaying two huge, extinct, emu-like birds on a _____ rock face might be 40 000 years old. Indigenous art has always connected the _____ with the present, the people with the land, and spirituality with reality. It is a source of _____ for Indigenous _____ today.

The rock art at Ubirr in Kakadu National Park is like a _____ of Indigenous art. There are examples of stories about law and behaviour in Rainbow Serpent paintings. Paintings from the last 1500 years show traditional food like fish, _____ and yams. A painting of a buffalo hunter from the 1880s illustrates contact with _____ people.

Indigenous art styles

- Rock art varied throughout Australia as Dreaming stories and food supplies differed from place to place. Some sites displayed the lives of the people, with drawings showing fish, animals, weapons and animal tracks as well as mythical beings. The **heritage-listed** Dampier Archipelago in Western Australia has many collections of rock art, as does Arnhem Land in the Northern Territory.
- Rock engravings or **petroglyphs** (*petro* meaning 'rock' and *glyph* meaning 'symbol') were carved into large flat **sandstones** by rubbing designs into them with a hard stone. The Olary region of South Australia has excellent examples – designs there include fish and crocodile heads.
- Rock paintings were made in shelters like caves. People used **ochre** to make red, yellow **kaolin** to make white, and charcoal to make black.
- **Hand painting** was very common, especially in the southern parts of Australia. Artists placed one hand on the surface of a cave or rock and blew ochre over it, leaving the outline. Examples of this can be seen in the Cave of Hands in the northern Grampians.
- In Arnhem Land, some paintings show the internal organs of humans and animals. This style is known as **X-ray art**.
- **Dot painting** began in the Central and Western desert. Artists used ochre, sand, blood, charcoal, small rocks, flowers, feathers and seeds to create the art on ground for ceremonial events. The paintings showed symbols of the landscape as well as Dreaming stories. The meanings of the symbols varied according to the tribe and the region where they were painted. In 1972, the community at Papunya, 240 kilometres north-west of Alice Springs, transferred the method to modern canvas using acrylic paints. Sacred objects were not allowed to be shown on modern paintings.
- For ceremonial occasions, Indigenous people painted their faces, arms and upper bodies with symbols, often relating to totems.

Different kinds of rock art

 Read the Resource sheet 'Indigenous painting styles' and complete the following sentences.

1 How were rock engravings made?

Rock engravings were made _____

2 What kinds of materials were used to make the first dot paintings?

To make traditional dot paintings, _____

3 Where was modern dot painting begun, and what was left out?

Modern dot painting began _____

4 Why did rock paintings vary?

Rock paintings varied because _____

5 What does X-ray art show and where is it found?

X-ray art shows _____

6 Why did Indigenous Australians paint their bodies?

Indigenous people painted their bodies _____

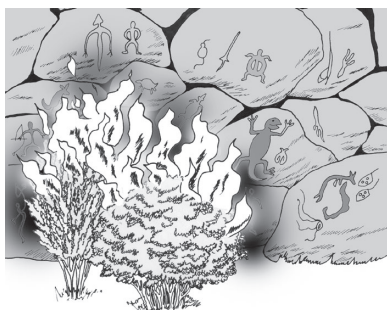
7 Where can hand painting be found?

Hand painting can be found _____

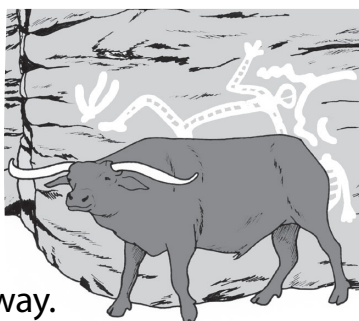
Threats to rock art

Rock art is important to Indigenous Australians as it records their history and culture. It must be preserved so that future generations of Australians can understand it and learn from it. In the past, Indigenous Australians regrooved and repainted rock art to preserve it. Cave art at Yuendumu in the Northern Territory cave art has recently been restored. Here are some of the threats to rock art:

- Moisture, fire and dust can cause damage to rock art.



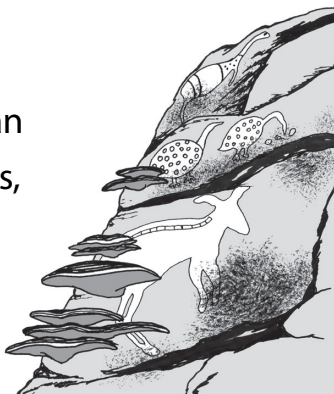
- Animals such as wild buffalo in the Northern Territory rub against paintings and wear them away.



- Birds and insects like mud wasps build nests on rock walls.



- Fungi and lichen can grow over paintings, especially in damp, tropical areas.



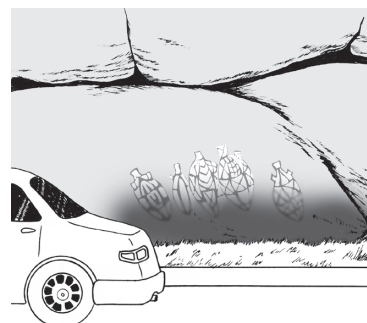
- Non-Indigenous people can damage the rock art by painting the grooves with white paint to try to preserve it; for example, near Bondi Beach.



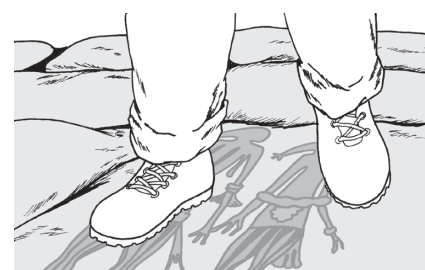
- In Esperance, Western Australia, graffiti has been scratched into paintings that are thousands of years old.



- Pollution in the atmosphere from cars and factories eats away the colours and patterns.



- Tourists treading on rock art can wear it away.



How can we help protect rock art?

Read the Resource sheet, 'Threats to rock art'.

 1 Fill in the speech bubbles with your ideas about ways to protect rock art.



2 Why must tourists understand the wishes of the Indigenous elders when they visit rock art sites?

Teacher's notes – European contact with Indigenous Australians

Achieve!

Objectives

- To understand that Europeans colonised other places because they wanted resources
- To appreciate the impact of colonisation on the Indigenous inhabitants of Australia
- To undertake mapping and interpretative tasks

Prior knowledge

Students should have some knowledge of migration to Australia from 1788 to the present, including the varying attitudes towards new arrivals.

Background

The first visitors to Northern Australia were the Macassans from modern-day Indonesia. They were searching for trepang (sea cucumbers) and traded with the Indigenous people. Signs of their presence remain in the Macassan words still present in Indigenous languages in the north.

During the 16th to 18th centuries, Europeans explored the world in search of resources. Explorers who encountered the west coast of Australia found it inhospitable.

Australia was the only British colony that was subject to the ruling of *terra nullius* (land belonging to no one), which contributed to the extreme disadvantage experienced by Indigenous Australians.

Starter activity

Discuss what students know about the first explorers to Australia, where they came from and why. Then develop a class list of different reasons why people want to come to Australia to live.

Resources and Activity sheets

Read the Resource sheet, 'Contact with Indigenous Australians', with the students. Explain to the students that there were also other visitors who are not listed in the table. Discuss the reasons why European nations wanted to expand their territory by colonising other places. Then have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Exploring Australia'. They will need to refer to the Resource sheet, 'Discovering Australia', to complete this activity. To extend the activity, you could have students list further factors that would be important to the first British settlers in sourcing food, water and shelter.

Have students read the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous contact with Europeans (1)'. Discuss the concept of *terra nullius* and what happened to Australia's original inhabitants as a result. Explain that this was the beginning of a radical change in lifestyle for Indigenous people. Then have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Indigenous contact with Europeans (2)'.

Extension activity

- Read about Governor Bourke's 1835 Proclamation of *Terra Nullius* with the class at: <http://www.migrationheritage.nsw.gov.au>, then use the website's search option with the key term: *terra nullius*.
The web page provides information about the social and political context in both Britain and Australia around the time of European occupation. It also discusses the fact that not all British people supported the way Australia was colonised.
- Lead a class discussion about the meaning of and connotations of the terms 'invaded' and 'colonised'. Discuss whether the Europeans invaded or colonised Australia, and encourage students to give reasons for their opinions.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Contact with Indigenous Australians

Sailors from several nations discovered various parts of the coast of *Terra Australis Incognita* (unknown south land), as Australian was then called. Some of these explorers came into contact with Indigenous Australians long before European occupation in 1788.

When	Who	Ship	Where/Why/What
1500 –1700	Macassans (Indonesian)	unknown	● Northern Australia ● Sea cucumber fishing ● Contact and trade with Indigenous people
1606	William Janszoon (Dutch)	<i>Duyfken</i>	● West Cape York Peninsula ● Clashed with Indigenous people
1606	Luis Vaes de Torres (Spanish)	unknown	● Sailed through Torres Strait ● Saw Australia
1616	Dirk Hartog (Dutch)	<i>Eendracht</i>	● Landed at Shark Bay, Western Australia
1619	Frederick de Houtman (Dutch)	<i>Dordrecht</i>	● Saw Rottnest Island ● Charted islands off the west coast
1629	Francisco Pelsart (Dutch)	<i>Batavia</i>	● Shipwrecked off north-west coast of Western Australia
1642–43	Abel Tasman (Dutch)	<i>Zeehaen</i>	● Claimed Van Diemen's Land (Tasmania)
1688	William Dampier (English)	<i>Roebuck</i>	● Landed near King Sound ● Met with Indigenous people
1770	Captain James Cook (English)	<i>Endeavour</i>	● Mapped the east coast from Point Hicks to Cape York ● Claimed east coast for Britain ● Saw Indigenous people

Discovering Australia

Title:



Key:

Exploring Australia

-  **1** Read the Resource sheet, 'Contact with Indigenous Australians'.
Look at the map of Australia on the Resource sheet, 'Discovering Australia'.
On the map, mark and label where the explorers went.
Use a key to identify the different explorers. Give the map a title.
Use the Resource sheets to help you answer the following questions.
- 2** Which nations sent explorers to the coast of Australia between 1500 and 1770?

- 3** Which nation sent the most explorers to Australia? _____
- 4** Of the groups listed in the table on the Resource sheet:
- a)** how many reported contact with the Indigenous people? _____
- b)** how many reported conflict with the Indigenous people? _____

People from other countries explored the Australian coastline many times from 1550–1770. Some were looking for food. Others wanted to expand their territories. It was a long sea voyage from Britain to Australia. The first British settlers could not bring many things with them. They had to find the things they needed in the area they settled.

- 5** Add vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete this information about the things the first British settlers needed when they arrived in Australia, and how these needs may have influenced where they chose to land and settle.

F__d: Fertile land with good average r__nfall to grow food

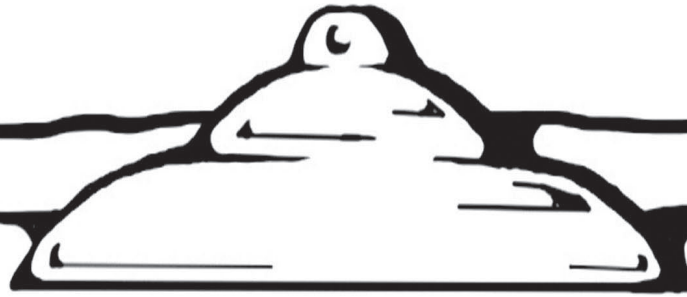
W__t__r: Sources of fr__sh water, such as cr__ks, lakes, and springs

Sh__lt__r: Level land to b__ild shelter; r__sourc__s such as t__mb__r to use for building

Tr__nsp__rt: Deep water so ships could harbour close to sh__r__ to make it easier to transport g__ds

- 6** The east coast of Australia receives high levels of annual rainfall. Why would this be attractive to the British when selecting land to settle?

Indigenous contact with Europeans (1)



The arrival of Captain Arthur Phillip from England with the First Fleet in 1788 changed the lives of Indigenous people forever. It took about 100 years for the impact of European occupation to reach the centre of Australia.

It is thought that there were about 750 000 Indigenous Australians when European settlers arrived. At first, the Indigenous Australians and the Europeans were curious about each other and treated each other with respect. However, this soon changed as the two groups could not understanding each other's culture.

Soon after the arrival of the colonists, diseases such as smallpox, influenza and measles spread throughout the Indigenous people, who had no immunity to them. This resulted in many deaths.

The land was not developed in a way the Europeans understood – there were no houses, fences or farmed animals. They took over the land, especially around waterholes and areas with fertile soil. They built towns and tried to farm the land the way people did in England.

The Europeans did not understand the Indigenous relationship with the land or their sustainable use of resources. Many conflicts occurred when Indigenous Australians resisted being pushed off their land.

The colonisation of Australia was based on the legal concept of *terra nullius*, which means 'land of no one'. In 1835, the British government officially declared Australia to be *terra nullius*.

Indigenous contact with Europeans (2)

-  1 Use what you have learned from the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous contact with Europeans (1)', to complete these sentences.

The lives of Indigenous people changed...
It took 100 years for...
When Europeans arrived...
The attitude of Indigenous people was...
Colonists brought diseases like...
Indigenous people died because...
Colonists took land...
The Europeans did not understand...
Conflict occurred because...
<i>Terra nullius</i> means...

Objectives

- To understand that we need to have laws in order for society to function
- To appreciate Indigenous law
- To gain an understanding of the conflict between Indigenous law and Australian law

Prior knowledge

Students should recognise right and wrong within a family, a community and a society and understand that there are consequences when the law is broken.

Background

Indigenous customary law came into being through the Dreaming, which determined the relationships between people and the land and became the basis of Indigenous culture. Laws were passed on through stories, song and dance. Different tribes had different specific laws.

When laws relating to social interaction were broken, the elders and community members met with victims and offenders. They resolved the issues with mediation and determined the punishments, which were dealt out quickly – sometimes these punishments seem harsh and violent to Europeans. When laws relating to sacred matters were broken, the elders generally determined the punishment.

After European occupation, Australian law was written down and was the province of the judicial system, with resolution of crimes taking a long time and involving jail for some matters. This led to some Indigenous Australians being placed in custody and resulted in conflict between the cultures.

Customary law is still practised today in some Indigenous communities.

Starter activity

Lead a discussion about the reasons we have laws, how they are made and who administers them. Introduce the idea of more than one system of law operating within a region.

Activity sheets

Read the Activity sheet, 'Customary law (1)', with the students. Discuss the fact that different tribes had slightly different laws, and how this could affect people travelling across tribal boundaries. Students will complete sentence starters to summarise what they have read. You could tell students that current Australian state and territory boundaries were not finalised until after 1901 when they were created at the time of Federation.

In the Activity sheet, 'Customary law (2)', students will explore further the traditions of Indigenous law. Students will need a dictionary to complete the first question. Point out that, unlike the Australian legal system, customary law did not separate religion, traditions and social rules.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Comparing customary law and Australian law'. Students will learn about some traditional punishments in customary law, and compare the dispute resolution process with the Australian legal system.

Read the Activity sheet, 'Circle sentencing', with the students. Sensitively discuss factors that could contribute to the higher percentage of Indigenous people in custody, such as cultural differences, lack of access to legal advice, and health and social issues such as remote locations and high unemployment rates.

To complete the activity sheet, 'Circle courts', students will need an atlas or access to a mapping application, and a blank map of Australia. A map is provided on the CD-ROM in the Artwork > Unit 6 folder. Discuss the distribution of courts in relation to population centres.

Extension ideas

Have students visit the website below to read more about circle sentencing and evaluate the importance and success of this process:

www.creativespirits.info/aboriginalculture/law/circle-sentencing

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

Customary law (1)

Indigenous Australians had developed a complex **system of law** thousands of years before Europeans came to Australia. Customary Indigenous law is based on **beliefs, culture** and **the land**, which all came from the **Dreaming**. Laws were passed down through generations using stories, song and dance.

Each tribe has their own system of law, so while there are many similarities between tribes, there are also many variations. Tribal areas were largely defined by language groups, although rivers and other natural features may have formed boundaries. In 1788, there were at least 250 tribal areas. Many tribes shared common areas which were used for ceremonies. People asked permission of neighbouring tribes if they wanted to travel through their lands.

 Read the information above, then complete these sentences.

- 1 Customary Indigenous law is _____.
- 2 There was no common Indigenous law because _____.
- 3 Stories, song and dance told _____.
- 4 Tribal areas were based on _____.
- 5 Common tribal areas were used for _____.
- 6 In 1788, there are 250 tribal areas, compared with _____ states and territories today.
- 7 Permission was sought to _____.

Customary law (2)

The Dreaming provides Indigenous Australians with much more than a set of rules or laws to follow. The Dreaming is the basis for **Indigenous lore** – a body of knowledge, beliefs, customs and traditions. Rules for how to behave (**customary law**), are a part of Indigenous lore. Indigenous lore sets out clear rules for the way society should function, including how everyone should behave, ceremonial relationships and who can marry.

Australian Law refers to the justice system introduced to Australia by the British colonists. This **legal system** was originally the same as the one in England.

In remote parts of Australia, customary law is still practised and this can come into **conflict** with the Australian legal system.

 **1** Write the terms in bold in the information above in your workbooks.

Use a dictionary and work with a partner to write a definition for each one.

2 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

There are two main parts to customary law: _____ law, and laws about how _____ treat each other. Indigenous people had few possessions and shared _____ like spears, digging sticks and coolamons, so there were no crimes against _____ property.

There are no courts or _____ sentences in customary law, but there are a variety of _____. A problem between people, such as _____ another person, was sorted out by community members, including the offender and the _____. Sometimes elders were involved too.

Elders were always involved in offences against sacred _____. These crimes related to sacred _____, objects, places and knowledge. For example, some _____ were sacred to _____, so men, children and uninitiated women were not allowed to visit them. In some _____, mentioning the name of a deceased person was _____ and subject to punishment.

Word bank

ceremonies
hurting
jail
law
people
personal
places
punishments
resources
sacred
taboo
tribes
victim
women

Comparing customary law and Australian law

In customary law, there are different punishments for different offences. Each tribe had its own system of crimes and punishments.

In the past, death through spearing or sorcery might be the consequence of breaking sacred law.

Spearing in the thigh could be used as payback for crimes such as murder, personal injury or adultery. In some tribes, people were banished for breaking laws.

Shaming was used to punish offences like neglecting family members and insulting behaviour.

 1 Identify three offences and the punishment for each.

- _____
- _____
- _____

Differences between Indigenous dispute resolution and the Australian legal system

Indigenous dispute resolution	Australian legal system
No written laws (customary)	Written laws
Family and community reach an agreement about the type of punishment and who will carry it out (consensus)	Strangers such as police and magistrates decide on the punishment
The offender and the victim and their families are involved in customary law processes	Lawyers defend the offender
The punishment is carried out within the community	The punishment may be a fine, community service or jail

2 Using the information above, write a paragraph in your workbook about the differences between traditional Indigenous dispute resolution and the Australian legal system.

Circle sentencing

In Australia there is a higher percentage of Indigenous Australians in jail than non-Indigenous Australians. In 2011, Indigenous people made up 26% of Australia's prison population but only 2.5% of the total population. In the Northern Territory, 83% of the prison population is Indigenous.

One strategy being used in New South Wales to try and reduce the number of Indigenous people in jail is **circle sentencing**. The 'circle' consists of four Indigenous elders, the offender, the victim, a defence lawyer and a magistrate. They try to work out a fair sentence for the offender that does not include going to jail. They talk about the background of the offender and the situation, and how the crime has affected the victim and the community. Often the sentence involves community work. People can only use circle sentencing if they plead guilty.

There are similar courts with different names in other states and territories. The sentences given are strict, but the process helps to reduce the number of people who re-offend.

 Read the information above and write four questions about it that you would like answered. Use the sentence starters provided. An example has been done for you.

Why is there a greater percentage of Indigenous people in jail than non-Indigenous people?

1 Why _____

2 Where _____

3 Which _____

4 How _____

Circle courts

-  1 You need an atlas and a blank map of Australia to complete this activity.
- The table lists the different names that states and territories have for circle courts, and the places these courts are located.
- Use an atlas to help you locate and mark the places on a map.

Australian Capital Territory <i>Ngambra Circle Court</i>	Canberra
New South Wales <i>Circle Sentencing</i>	Nowra, Bourke, Walgett, Dubbo, Moree, Lismore, Kempsey, Blacktown
Northern Territory <i>Community Court</i>	Darwin, Nhulunbuy, Tiwi Islands, Yuendumu
Queensland <i>Murri Court, Youth Murri Court</i>	Brisbane, Mount Isa, Cairns, Charters Towers, Toowoomba, St George
South Australia <i>Nunga Court, (Special) Aboriginal Court</i>	Port Adelaide, Murray Bridge, Port Lincoln, Port Augusta, Berri
Victoria <i>Koori Court</i>	Mildura, Swan Hill, Shepparton, Broadmeadows, Warrnambool, Bairnsdale
Western Australia <i>Circle Court, Aboriginal Court, Community Court</i>	Perth, Norseman, Kalgoorlie

-  Discuss the following questions with a partner and write the answers in your workbook.
- 2 Describe the distribution of the circle sentencing courts.
- 3 Suggest why Tasmania does not use circle sentencing.
- 4 Why do you think there are fewer circle courts in the Northern Territory, Western Australia and the Australian Capital Territory compared to other states?

Objectives

- To understand the need for good health, education, employment and income opportunities
- To recognise differences between Indigenous and non-Indigenous health and opportunities
- To appreciate ways to overcome this disparity, and to be aware of the variations between urban and remote Indigenous people
- To improve mapping and graphing skills

Prior knowledge

No prior knowledge required.

Background

Indigenous people had no resistance to diseases such as measles, smallpox and influenza, which were brought to Australia by European settlers. Traditional diets were well-balanced and contained little fat. Modern urban diets can be high in fat and sugar and low in fibre, which has been linked to obesity, diabetes and heart disease. These influences, plus other lifestyle factors acquired from Europeans such as smoking and alcohol consumption, have contributed to the high incidence of kidney and other diseases in Indigenous Australians. As a result, Indigenous life expectancy is not as high as it is for non-Indigenous people.

In remote centres, lack of education reduces employment opportunities and contributes to social problems.

Indigenous people in other countries such as New Zealand and the United States also experience disadvantages.

Starter activity

This is a sensitive topic that relates to low socio-economic areas as well as to Indigenous people. Ask students to think about the things they need to lead a healthy life and to have a successful future. Point out that not all the people who are disadvantaged are Indigenous, that not all Indigenous people are disadvantaged and that many Indigenous people have been successful in fields such as law, medicine, music and sport.

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Activity sheet, 'What happened after European settlers arrived?', with the students. Make sure students understand the meaning of the terms shown in bold. Students could work in pairs to answer the questions.

Examine the graph on the Activity sheet, 'Australian populations', with the students. Make sure they understand how to read and interpret the graph. Discuss why these statistics are a valuable measure of Australian society.

Have students complete the mapping activity on the Activity sheet, 'Distance from major cities'. They will need an atlas or access to a mapping application, and a blank map of Australia. A map is provided on the CD-ROM in the Artwork > Unit 7 folder.

Read and discuss the Resource sheet, 'Opportunities in Australia (1)', with the class. Then have them complete the Activity sheet, 'Opportunities in Australia (2)'. You could extend this activity by exploring the website: <http://www.indigenous.gov.au> with the students, which provides further information about the government's Closing the Gap policy. Students could list current government projects that are aimed at each category listed on the Activity sheet.

Extension ideas

- Students could research Indigenous people from another country and compare their treatment and outcomes with Australia's Indigenous people; for example, the Maori people in New Zealand, the Inuit people in Canada or the Native Americans in the United States.
- Have students research the history of the White Australia Policy in Australia.

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

After European settlers arrived

When Europeans settled Australia in 1788, life for Indigenous people was changed forever. Indigenous people were driven inland as the new settlers took over coastal land for farming. Indigenous Australians did not have any **resistance** to European diseases like **influenza** and **smallpox**, so many died – causing the population to drop, especially near the coast. Over time, the Indigenous people's way of life was changed and their diet altered, especially with the introduction of sugar and flour. This led to an increase in the rate of medical problems like **diabetes**, **kidney disease**, **heart disease**, and **eye** and **ear** problems. It took much longer for Indigenous people in inland regions to be affected by new settlers looking for land.

From the end of the 19th century until the 1970s, many children were taken from their families by government officials and placed in **institutions**. It was believed that this would help them to fit into European society. This caused significant and lasting damage to the children, their families and their tribes.

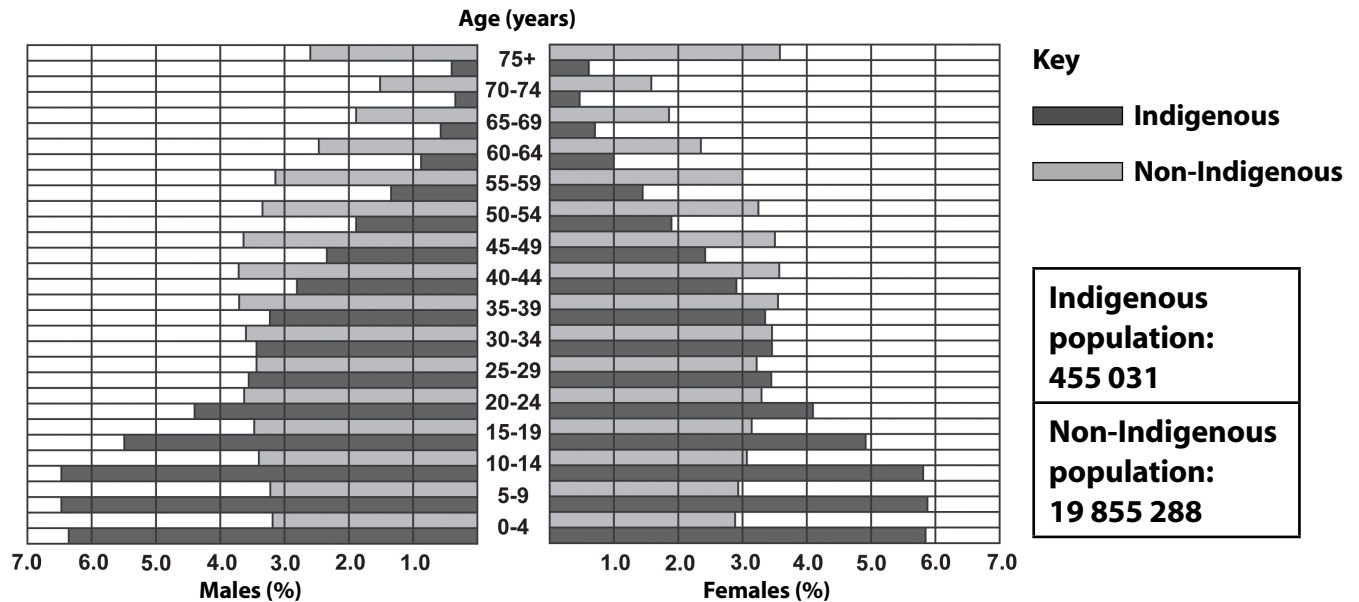
Overall, Australia has a very high standard of living. But there are distinct differences in standard of living between some Indigenous and non-Indigenous people.

 Use the information above to help you answer the following questions.
Write your answers in your workbook.

- 1 What does 'standard of living' mean?
- 2 Why were Indigenous people driven inland?
- 3 How was the traditional Indigenous diet affected?
- 4 What happened to the health of Indigenous people?
- 5 What was the government policy regarding Indigenous children? Why?
- 6 Why did it take longer for Indigenous Australians living inland to be affected?

Australian populations

Indigenous and non-Indigenous populations in Australia, 2006



Source: Experimental estimates of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Island Australians, June 2006 (ABS. Cat. No. 3288.0.55.001.)

Use the graph above to answer the following questions.

1 Which age group has:

- the most Indigenous people? _____
- the fewest Indigenous people? _____
- the most non-Indigenous people? _____
- the fewest non-Indigenous people? _____

2 In which age groups are there:

- a larger percentage of Indigenous people than non-Indigenous people? _____

- a smaller percentage of Indigenous people than non-Indigenous people? _____

3 What do you think these statistics tell us about Indigenous people and non-Indigenous people?

Distance from major cities

Living further away from a major city makes it more difficult for people to obtain goods, health care, education, jobs and social support.

 You need an atlas and a blank map of Australia to complete this activity.

- 1 Use an atlas to locate and mark the places listed below on the map.
Then create a key to show how remote each location is.

Remote:	Alice Springs, Esperance, Karratha, Mt Isa
Very remote:	Coober Pedy, Tennant Creek, Yuendumu, Fitzroy Crossing, Warburton (WA), Maralinga
Inner regional:	Hobart, Noosa, Tamworth
Outer regional:	Darwin, Cairns, Whyalla
Major cities:	Perth, Adelaide, Sydney, Brisbane, Melbourne

- 2 Use the scale to measure how far it is between these places.

- Adelaide and Coober Pedy _____
- Adelaide and Alice Springs _____
- Alice Springs and Yuendumu _____
- Darwin and Melbourne _____
- Perth and Warburton _____
- Brisbane and Mt Isa _____

- 3 How easy would it be for a person living in Fitzroy Crossing to access services and employment?

Opportunities in Australia (1)

The federal government has a 'Closing the Gap' policy, which aims to reduce the disadvantages experienced by Indigenous people.

Indigenous people

As a man I hope to live to 67.



Women should live to 72.



I am three times more likely to die of cardiovascular disease.



It is difficult to get to school some days.



My average income is \$718 per week.



My chances of having a job are up to 85%, depending on where I live.



Non-Indigenous people

I expect to live to 78.



My mother should live to 82.



My chance of dying from cardiovascular disease is less, especially if I don't smoke.



I have go to school each day.



My average wage is \$941 per week.



I have a 95% chance of getting a job.



Opportunities in Australia (2)

-  1 Read what the people say on the Resource sheet, 'Opportunities in Australia (1)'. Summarise in your own words the experiences of Indigenous and non-Indigenous people. One answer has been done for you.

Classification	Summary of experiences
Employment	
Life expectancy	<i>Indigenous men have a shorter life expectancy than non-Indigenous men.</i>
Income	
Education	
Health	

Objectives

- To understand the difference between weather and climate
- To appreciate the importance of weather observations in Indigenous life
- To compare Indigenous and European interpretations of climatic events
- To learn how to graph and analyse data

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of the impact of weather on the clothes they wear, their sporting activities and decisions about holiday destinations.

Background

Weather and climate play a very important part in our decision making and daily lives. Early Indigenous Australians made detailed observations of weather, as their survival depended on knowledge of plant germination and growth, and the cycles of animals. This knowledge is linked to their sustainable use of the land and to the Dreaming. Indigenous Australians in different areas had many different experiences, as the size of the Australian continent and its topography created diverse conditions. Information was passed orally from generation to generation. Detailed accounts of the climate of northern Australia still exist, as well as for south-western Australia, the Grampians and the Sydney region. However, Indigenous climate information for the south-east of Australia has largely been lost due to European occupation.

The concept of four seasons, which the Europeans brought from the Northern Hemisphere, does not really fit with the Indigenous seasons. Up to six seasons have been identified in south-west Australia and the Northern Territory, and three in the centre of Australia.

Indigenous knowledge of weather and climate is now being recognised by the scientific community as a valuable contribution to the climate change discussion. Climate change is expected to contribute further to erosion of coastlines and rising sea levels. This may force some Torres Strait Island communities to move, causing physical and social disruption.

Starter activity

Ask students to brainstorm why we need to know about the weather and climate. Discuss which occupations depend on this information. Explore the idea that today, a change in the weather doesn't much affect whether people go to work or school not, where people live or what people eat. Why do the students think Indigenous Australians need to know about the weather?

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Activity sheet, 'The Australian Climate', with the class. Students will rearrange sentence fragments and rewrite complete sentences about seasons from a European and Indigenous perspective.

Have students complete the Activity sheet, 'Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT'. Maningrida is a town in the Northern Territory on the north coast of Arnhem Land. Students will complete a climate graph by continuing to plot the data from a table.

Read the Resource sheet, 'Yolgnu seasons', with the class. Students will learn about the features of the different Yolgnu seasons, and how this affects where the Yolgnu live and what they do.

To complete the Activity sheet, 'Yolgnu and Maningrida seasons', students will need the completed Activity sheet, 'Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT', and the Resource sheet, 'Yolgnu seasons'. Students will answer questions to help them analyse and interpret the information provided.

Extension ideas

Students could research climate data for their local area, or an area they would like to visit, and graph the data using the climate graph on the Activity sheet, 'Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT' as a model.

The Australian climate

There are a variety of different climates within Australia. These different climates are due to factors such as latitude (how close you are to the equator), altitude (height above sea level) and distance from the coast. Indigenous Australians closely observe the weather as it is critical to their food supply, their shelter and their links to the land. Europeans introduced their ideas of four distinct seasons, but most parts of Australia do not fit this classification of climate.

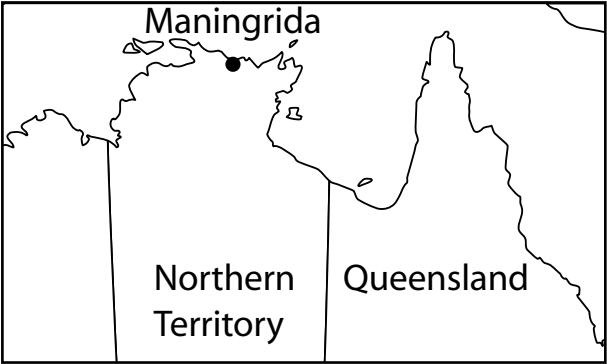
 Write these sentence fragments in the correct order.

- 1 experience all four seasons. one of the places in Australia to Canberra is
-
-
- 2 storms bring rain In summer, to Sydney.
-
- 3 suggested to Gadgerong people could be found. that crocodile eggs March flies
-
-
- 4 according to location. vary seasonal cycles According to Indigenous people,
-
-
- 5 The names of the seasons the plants and animals available. usually reflected
-
-
- 6 rain might fall. In Central Australia, it was thought that when a plover was seen
-
-

Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT

Indigenous Australians in north-east Arnhem Land identified six seasons.

Europeans in the north of Australia refer to two seasons: the **Wet** and the **Dry**. The time before the Wet is often referred to as the *build up*.



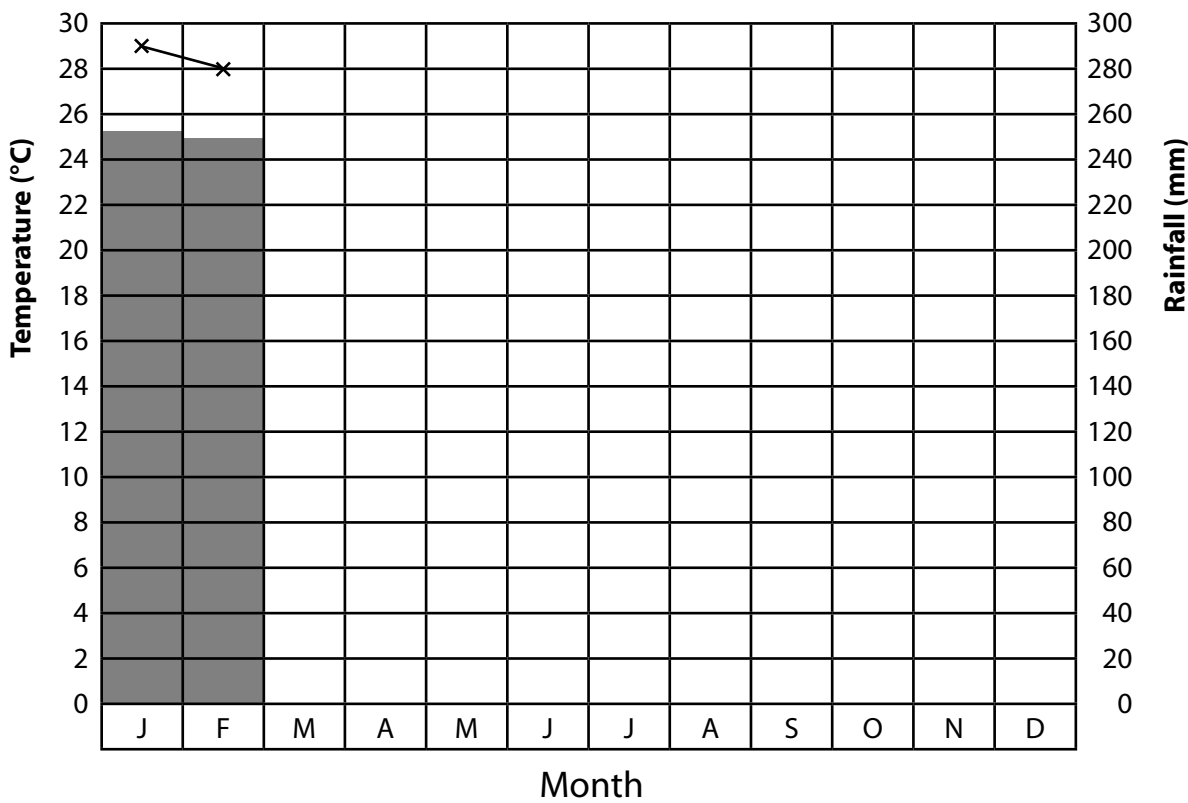
Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT
(Latitude: 12.05°S Longitude: 134.23°E)

Statistics	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Average temperature (°C)	29	28	28	27	26	24.5	23.5	24	26	27	28.5	29
Average rainfall (mm)	253	248	257	93	9	0	0	0	0	0.5	33	197

(adapted from www.bom.gov.au)

- 1 Use the climate statistics for **Maningrida** to complete the climate graph.
Draw a line to connect the temperatures and draw columns to show rainfall.
January and February have been done for you.

Average monthly temperature and rainfall in Maningrida, NT



Yolgnu seasons

The Yolgnu people are from north-eastern Arnhem Land in the Northern Territory.

Season name	Months	Weather	Seasonal activities
Mirdawarr	Late March, April	End of wet season. South-east wind but hot and humid.	● People live in camps as floodwater prevents much movement. ● Fishing and goose-hunting. ● Plant foods becoming easily available.
Dhaarratharramirri	Late April, May, June, July, August	Dry season. Wind from east and south-east.	● People are more nomadic. ● Burning of grassed areas, group hunting of kangaroos, bandicoots and goannas. Fishing is important. ● Ceremonial activities begin in August
Rarranhdharr	September, October	Hot dry season. Wind mainly from north-east, first thunderstorms heard.	● An important time for ceremonies. ● After burning grass, people don't move far. ● Fish spearing in estuaries and along the coast. ● Stringybark in flower.
Worlmamirri	Late October, November, December	Most heat and humidity before rainy season. Many violent thunderstorms.	● People stay in camps near permanent water supplies.
Baarramirri	Late December, January	Short season with north-west wind. Wet season begins.	● People stay in wet season camps as travel inland is prevented by floods and dense, tall grass.
Gurnmul	January, February, March	The real wet season occurs.	● People remain in camps as floods prevent movement inland.

Yolgnu and Maningrida seasons

 You need the completed Activity sheet, 'Climate statistics for Maningrida, NT', and the Resource sheet, 'Yolgnu Seasons', to answer the following questions.

- 1 In Maningrida, which months have the highest temperatures? _____
- 2 Which month has the lowest temperatures? _____
- 3 Which European seasons have the highest rainfall? _____
- 4 Which months do you think are part of the Wet? _____

- 5 Circle the 'European seasons' that match the Wet: summer autumn winter spring
- 6 Which months do you think are part of the Dry? _____

- 7 Circle the 'European seasons' that match the Dry: summer autumn winter spring
- 8 Do you think it would be humid in February in Maningrida? Explain why.

- 9 When is the dry season according to the Yolgnu people? _____

- 10 Suggest why people are more nomadic during Dhaarratharramirri.

- 11 Explain why ceremonies happen during Dhaarratharramirri and Rarranhdharr.

- 12 Which direction does the wind come from during Baarramirri? _____
- 13 Look at the location map for Maningrida and explain why this wind brings rain.

- 14 With a partner, discuss the differences between the Indigenous and European seasons. Which system do you think is more accurate for your area of Australia?

Impacts of climate change

 1 Use the word bank to complete the information below.

Impact of climate change

Torres Strait Islanders are very worried about _____ change.

Already they have observed stronger _____, more storms, removal of land through _____ and rougher seas. These are changes the _____ have not seen before.

With more storms and a _____ rise in sea level, the Torres Strait Islanders might experience _____ in getting fresh water. Cultural sites like _____ near the shore might be flooded. Their _____, sewerage systems, power supplies, roads and _____ might also be flooded.

The numbers of animals and plants such as turtles and _____ will be affected. Indigenous _____ will have to change as some plants and animals disappear. Some people might have to move, which will mean a loss of their _____ and sustainable lifestyle.

In Cape York, Indigenous knowledge is helping park rangers _____ the effects of climate change on land and shorelines.

Word bank

predicted

graves

manage

climate

elders

culture

homes

winds

dugongs

erosion

difficulty

airstrips

knowledge

2 Describe the possible impacts of climate change in the Torres Strait Islands. Compare this with the possible impacts on the place you live.

Objectives

- To appreciate the importance of tourism for Indigenous people
- To understand the role of Indigenous people in Australian tourism
- To identify reasons that visitors take part in Indigenous tourism

Prior knowledge

Students should understand that people visit places away from home for a variety of reasons.

Background

Indigenous tourists can be domestic – from Australia – or international. Indigenous tourists visit at least one Indigenous cultural site, art gallery, museum or Indigenous community.

The Australian Tourism Authority actively encourages and promotes Indigenous tourism, as do state government departments. Indigenous tourism allows overseas and Australian visitors to appreciate Australian Indigenous culture, past and present, as well as places of cultural significance.

Indigenous tourism is run by Indigenous people or part-owned by Indigenous people. Alternatively, Indigenous people may be employed as guides and in other capacities. Indigenous tours have become more popular as people are becoming aware of the rich heritage and culture of Indigenous Australians. Their history of sustainable use of resources has also created interest. Indigenous tour operators provide a range of nature-based tourism events, cultural heritage and education programs on topics such as bush tucker, medicines, art and craft, as well as performances.

Starter activity

Create a class list of students' tourism experiences. Classify them into categories, such as visiting family and friends, cultural, ecotourism, sport, relaxation and retail. Explain that Indigenous tourism is increasingly important in Australia, especially for Indigenous Australians employed in tourism who can showcase their culture and history.

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous tourism (1)', with the class. This provides examples of the great variety of activities and cultural experiences available. Discuss the different types of attractions tourists want to visit, and which attractions the students would most like to visit. Then have students complete the writing frame on the Activity sheet, 'Indigenous tourism (2)'.

To complete the mapping exercise on the Activity sheet, 'Indigenous tourism – locations', students will need the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous tourism (1)', and an atlas or mapping application. Some students may need assistance with developing a key for the different kinds of attractions.

Provide students with the Activity sheet, 'Indigenous tourism visitors'. Discuss what the graph shows – numbers of International and domestic tourism visitors – and how to read the data presented. Explain that while these visitors do not exclusively look for Indigenous experiences, they include at least one in their plans. Note that the decreasing numbers of tourists largely reflects the effects of the global financial crisis and the increasing value of the Australian dollar.

Read the Activity sheet, 'Being a responsible tourist', with the class, which provides tips about being respectful at Indigenous tourism attractions. Students will use this information to help them explain why it is important for tourists to respect Indigenous culture.

Extension ideas

Have students choose a region such as the Kimberley, Uluru or Kadadu, and research a journey through the region with an Indigenous guide. They could create an itinerary and a visual diary to record the things they would expect to see.

Indigenous tourism (1)

Indigenous tourism has become increasingly popular due to a growing interest in the traditions, culture and sustainable lifestyle of the original inhabitants of Australia. In 2010, Indigenous tourism generated \$3.8 billion dollars, from both domestic and international visitors. This money has provided an income for Indigenous tourism operators and employees.

Read why these people want to take part in Indigenous tourism.



Indigenous tourism (2)

 1 Complete the writing frame below.

The Resource sheet, 'Indigenous tourism (1)', explains why...

One reason the German tourist has come to Australia is...

because it is...

The Chinese tourist wants to...

so that they...

Artists want to see...

People want to visit the Dreaming Trail to see...

Other visitors want to go with an Indigenous guide...

or to camp...

To sum up, tourists want to take part in a variety of activities including...

Indigenous tourism – locations

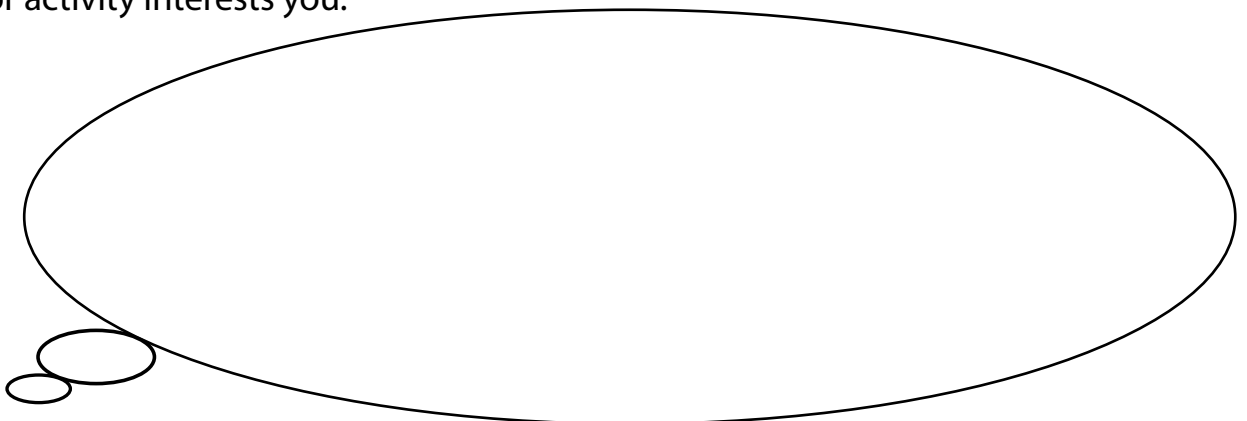
 **1** You need the Resource sheet, 'Indigenous tourism (1)' and an atlas.

Locate the tourism sites on the map.

Make a key to represent the different kinds of attractions.



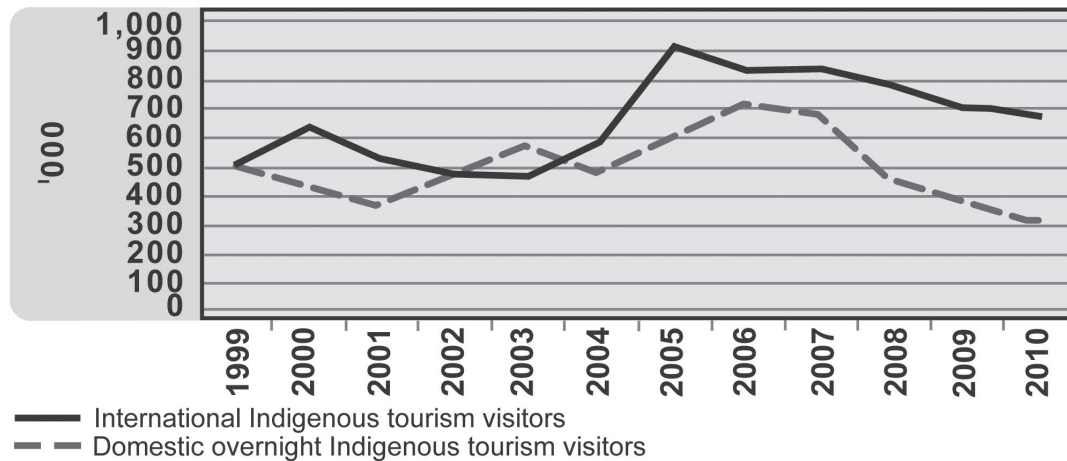
2 Where would you like to visit? Describe the location and explain why that particular place or activity interests you.



Indigenous tourism visitors

Use the graph to help you answer the questions below.

International and domestic Indigenous tourism visitors, 1999-2010



Source: Tourism Research Australia (TRA) International Visitor Survey (IVS) and National Visitor Survey (NVS)

- How many international Indigenous tourism visitors were there in 2000? _____
- How many more international visitors were there in 2005 than in 2000? _____
- In which year were there more domestic visitors than international visitors? _____
- Which year had the highest number of domestic visitors? _____
- What was the total number of Indigenous tourism visitors in 2005? _____
- What happened to the number of Indigenous tourism visitors between 2007 and 2010?

- What might have contributed to this?

- Suggest why there were more international Indigenous tourism visitors than domestic visitors for most of the decade.

Being a responsible tourist

The Australian government actively promotes the involvement of Indigenous people in tourism as it is a way for them to display their heritage and earn an income. It is important that Indigenous culture, beliefs and sites are treated with respect. Here are some ways to be a responsible tourist.

Always respect people’s privacy.

Some places may only be visited by men or by women.

You may need a permit to enter many Indigenous communities and lands.

Some places of cultural importance may not always be open to visitors – respect these closures.

Be aware that English may be a second language for many Indigenous people.

Always ask permission to photograph Indigenous people, cultural activities and places.

Ensure you buy a souvenir from Indigenous people as this helps them to support their families.

 1 Explain why it is important for tourists to respect Indigenous culture.

Objectives

- To understand the reasons for native title and Indigenous land use agreements
- To create and analyse a graph
- To learn about and empathise with the traditional values of Indigenous Australians

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of what belonging to a family or community means. They should also be aware that traditions can be expressed in many ways.

Background

When Australia was occupied by the Europeans, Indigenous people were subjected to dispossession of their lands and a lack of understanding of their culture. The Indigenous population was severely diminished by introduced diseases. There were many instances of conflict between Indigenous people and European settlers. In the late 19th and early 20th centuries, many Indigenous people were forced to live on missions and reserves. The European approach to assimilation resulted in the stolen generations. It was not until 1967 that Indigenous people were counted in the national census.

In 1992, after ten years of hard work by Eddie Mabo and his friends, native title was recognised. However, it can be difficult to prove in the courts.

Indigenous land use agreements are a voluntary agreement between traditional owners and people who want to use the land. These agreements don't require native title, but can help to support a native title claim. They are a way for people to work out a mutually beneficial way of managing and/or developing an area. Common land uses include pastoral grazing and mining.

Starter activity

Discuss native title with the students, and find out what they know or think they know about it. In particular, explore which categories of land the students think can be subject to native title – such as houses, farms, and national parks. (Many people are unaware that native title can only apply to government-owned land, national parks, public land and pastoral leases.) Record their ideas in a chart or mind map for later review.

Resource and Activity sheets

Read the Resource sheet, 'History of native title', with the students. Make sure students understand that Mabo's victory was important to more people than those in the Murray Islands – it meant that other Indigenous people could also apply for native title for their own land. On the Activity sheet, 'About native title', students will answer questions relating to the information of the Resource sheet.

Have students complete the cloze activity on the Activity sheet, 'Indigenous land use agreements'. Tell the students that the areas covered by ILUAs are private and must be respected, which is why people need permits to enter places such as Uluru. It may be useful to discuss the similarities and differences between ILUAs and native title before students answer the second question.

Extension ideas

- Review the chart from the discussion in the starter activity. Work with the students to correct and add to it as needed.
- Students could research the life and work of Eddie Mabo, and prepare a report outlining why the Mabo case is so important.
- The Indigenous Land Corporation is an independent statutory authority of the federal government which helps Indigenous people to buy and manage land. Students could explore their website and prepare a report outlining what they do, and what has been achieved: <http://www.ilc.gov.au>

Suggested web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

History of native title

The occupation of Australia in 1788 by the British was based on the principle of *terra nullius*, which means 'land belonging to no one'. At the time, British law allowed the settlement of 'uninhabited or barbarous country'. They did not understand the Indigenous way of occupying, using and connecting to the land. The British took over the land, especially around waterholes and areas with fertile soil. They built towns and tried to farm the land the way people did in Britain.

In 1982, **Eddie Mabo** argued that the Queensland government should recognise that Indigenous people on the Murray Islands, his original home in the **Torres Strait**, already had a system of law and customary use of the land at the time of British occupation. In June 1992, five months after Mabo's death, the **High Court of Australia** decided that Mabo was right. **Native title** was recognised and this overturned the idea of *terra nullius*.

Native title means that Australian law recognises some Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islanders' **rights to their land and waters**, based on their laws and customs. In order to gain native title, Indigenous people have to prove an unbroken connection to their land and waters.

Native title can only be gained on **Crown land** (government-owned land), national parks, public land and pastoral leases, and it cannot be sold. Native title allows Indigenous people to live in the area, camp, carry out traditional ceremonies, hunt, fish and gather food, as well as visit and protect important sites. Native title can only be gained through the courts.

About native title

Read the Resource sheet, 'History of native title', then complete the activities below.

History

-  **1** What happened in 1788? _____

- 2** Was the ruling of *terra nullius* correct? Explain your answer. _____

- 3** Why is Eddie Mabo regarded as a hero by many people? _____

Native title

- 4** What does **native title** mean? _____

- 5** How do Indigenous people gain native title over their land?

- 6** What kinds of areas can be claimed for native title? _____

- 7** How can land under native title be used? _____

Indigenous land use agreements

-  1 Use the word bank to complete the information about Indigenous land use agreements (ILUAs).

Word bank						
cattle	courts	cultural	easier	employment	land	native
species	support	tourism	telescope	traditional		

An Indigenous land use agreement (ILUA) is a way for Indigenous people to make agreements about the way _____ can be used or managed, even if they don't have _____ title. For example, _____ owners could make agreements about land use for mining, residential developments or grazing _____. They will be consulted about the details of any development, and can arrange important things like protecting _____ sites and restoring native _____. An ILUA can also provide benefits such as _____ and training.

It is _____ and faster to arrange an ILUA than to complete the process of applying for native title through the _____. Also, an ILUA can help people with native title claims.

An ILUA can be used to allow development like mining in the Kimberley or _____ in the Grampians – there is even an ILUA in Western Australia between the Wajarri Yamatji people and CSIRO. It allows the construction of a new radio _____ while protecting heritage values and providing money and training and employment opportunities to _____ the Wajarri Yamatji people in maintaining cultural ties to their land.

- 2 Explain why it is important to have Indigenous land use agreements, as well as native title.

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The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the needs of your students.

Topics include

Origins of the Australian continent
Dreamtime
Land management
Indigenous art
Contact with Europeans

Tribal law and Australian law
Health and opportunities
Indigenous climate
Indigenous tourism
Native Title

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